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Submitter Information

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General Comment

I am both a writer and the publisher of a small publishing line, About Comics. As a writer, I create copyrighted content, and as a publisher, I license copyrighted content from others for publishing. The copyrighted content that America creates is one of its great strengths -- the world devour our movies, our TV shows, our music, our comic books, and more, both generating income for American creators and companies and acting as ambassador for America around the world. Whether it be Friends, Iron Man, or Snoopy, the world takes inspiration from American creative product.

People at heavily-funded, money-losing AI companies are asking that creators sacrifice their rights and allow AI to be "trained" to copy their product. This product, derived from all these copyrighted creative work, will be in competition with the material it was trained on. In addition, the works created by AI may not be copyrightable themselves, not only in other countries, but even in the US itself, where existing case law stands against it. As such, it will be quite limited in how effectively it can be monetized. Smoothing the path for this is like taking apart a dollar-printing machine so the parts can be used to make nickels.

America has a large body of work in the public domain, much that is quite wonderful and creative. If Large Language Models must be trained, let them feed on that feast. If it must feast on new stuff to do what they seek to do, then it's looking to copy its novelty, which is much the thing that copyright was intended to defend.

AI has a lot of potential in research, in finding interesting patterns and prospects that humans cannot find. Its use in the creative arts, however, is likely to injure the very creative part of that, the thing of most value, and to do it at the expense of hard working creators. Please do not take steps with that as the goal.